Brian Gross

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Visual Storytelling Leader

Turning innovative and ambitious graphic design into a competitive advantage for media organizations through strategic planning, cross-functional collaboration and talent development.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Washington Post, Washington D.C. (2010-2026)

Modernized design operations at one of the world's most respected newsrooms during a period of significant growth, aligning teams, processes and priorities. Amplified the defining journalism of the era through premium immersive presentations, positioning the organization as an industry leader.

- Acquired top talent and managed a team of 50+ editors, art directors, developers.
- Led design at scale as newsroom doubled and company returned to profitability.
- Resulted in audience of 75m monthly visitors, 3m subscribers, 7.5m social followers.
- Contributed to 14 Pulitzers and 17 finalists by embedding design at earliest stages.

Director, News Design Department (2024-2026)

- Edited and managed assignments for 200 high-impact presentations, 1,800 social posts and 1,200 illustrations.
- Standardized data collection, tracking and analysis by defining goals at project start.
- Formed a task force to launch reusable tools, resulting in 5.1m views on 104 stories.
- Scaled in-house illustration expertise to reduce reliance on external vendors.
- Drove a newsroom style guide and color palette update, unblocking project delays and aligning stakeholders.
- Accelerated AI adoption by leading advisory groups and driving workflow efficiency.

Deputy Director, News Design Department (2014-2024)

- Established a restrained, content-first identity to be a signal in the noise.
- Transitioned print designers into developers through targeted training, skill sharing.
- Doubled staff to 50 and added managers to meet demand for ambition and quality.
- Introduced dedicated roles for project editing, illustrated reporting, motion graphics and digital infrastructure.
- Collaborated on branding for verticals, podcasts, games and Apple News.
- Built a culture of growth where designers could experiment and pitch ideas.
- Retained and promoted top performers through mentoring and career development.

Senior Designer (2010-2014)

- Took on leadership responsibility while raising the bar for creativity, experimentation.
- Gained fluency in tools and daily creative challenges to advocate for designers.
- Conceived, project managed and edited visual stories of all sizes.

University of Maryland College of Journalism, College Park MD (2026)

Adjunct lecturer teaching graduate-level students to create multimedia storytelling and build responsive websites using wireframes, HTML, CSS and data visualization tools.

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE

- **The Boston Globe,** Boston MA: Sports Designer and Team Leader (2002-2010)
- **San Diego Union-Tribune,** San Diego CA: Sports Designer (1999-2002)
- **Savannah Morning News**, Savannah GA: News Designer (1996-1999)
- **Kinston Free-Press**, Kinston NC: Reporter and Designer (1994-1995)
- **Suburban Journals**, Belleville IL: Reporter and Photographer (1994)

AWARDS

Pulitzer Prize (Staff)
National Reporting for AR-15 series, 2024; Public Service for January 6 coverage, 2022

Society for News Design
World's Best Digital (2020, 2025); Best in Show (2020, 2024); World's Best Newspaper Finalist (2013-15, 2020, 2022); multiple silver medals and portfolio awards

Society of Publication Designers: Gold Medal (2024)

SERVICE

Society for News Design
Creative Competition Judge (2005, 2016), Digital Competition Chair (2019–2024); Team Captain (2025-2026), Workshop Speaker (2002, 2005, 2015, 2025, 2026)

Poynter Leadership Academy
(2006, 2015)

Society of Publication Designers
Coffee + Convo mentor (2025)

Montgomery Soccer Inc
Coach of high school girls rec team for 15 seasons (2016-2024)

CONSULTING

Digital and print design clients
Philadelphia Inquirer
University of Tampa Journal
Wake Forest Magazine

EDUCATION

Southern Illinois University
Carbondale IL
Bachelor's in Journalism

Dow Jones News Fund
Training at University of Missouri

Columbus Dispatch
Copy Editing Intern

The Daily Egyptian
Editor-in-Chief